Smriti Ganapathi

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Education

2027 (Expected) **PhD in Public Policy, University of Chicago**
PhD scholarship by The Pearson Institute
Dissertation Title - "Enforcement, Norms, Framing: How Institutional Decisions Shape Gender-Based Violence"

2018 **M.Sc. Economics and Social Sciences, Bocconi University**
Admitted with a merit scholarship
Dissertation Title - "Tackling violence against women: can laws change perceptions?"

Working Papers & Works in Progress

- ***The Impact of Victim-Centric Institutions on Sex Offense Perpetration*** [JMP]
  with Daniela Horta-Saenz & Mazeeda Karani
- ***Policing Intimate Partner Violence: Curbing Abuse or Shifting It?***
- ***The Impact of Social Movements on Rape Rhetoric: Evidence from India***
- ***What is Truly Cultural? The Impact of Historical Information on Social Norms***

Policy Writing

- Oeindrila Dube, Smriti Ganapathi, Soeren J. Henn, and James A. Robinson. 2020. "Farmer-Herder Conflict in Nigeria's Middle Belt: Evidence from 288 Communities." *Policy Report*.

Employment

Teaching Experience

Oct 2023 **Instructor: Program Evaluation,** University of Chicago
Designed and taught an online intensive course for international policy students & practitioners.

Feb 2026 **Guest Lecturer: Violence in Schools,** University of Chicago

Oct 2022 - Mar 2026 **Teaching Assistant,** University of Chicago
Leading TA sessions:
Statistics (Master's; 2024, 2026), Program Evaluation (Master's; 2023), Advanced Microeconomics (PhD; 2023, 2024).
Supervising research:
Education & Economic Development (BA; 2026)

Research Experience

Jul 2019 – Jul 2021 **Pre-doctoral Research Assistant,** University of Chicago
Quasi-experimental projects & RCTs around conflict and gender.

Jun 2018 – Dec 2018 **Field Research Associate,** J-PAL
RCT on women's and children's health, overseeing primary data collection from over 10,000 households in 223 villages in India.

Employment (continued)

Multilateral Organizations

Mar 2019 – Jul 2019 — **Evaluation Intern,** International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)
Synthesized findings from 30 projects on community-driven development.

Jan 2018 – Apr 2018 — **Intern - Crime Statistics,** UN Office on Drugs and Crime
Compiled statistics on gender-based violence and contributed to the "Global Study on Homicide" 2019 report.

Grants & Scholarships

2026; 2023 — $16,000, Development Economics Research Fund, University of Chicago & Norwegian School of Economics – "Sexual Violence in South Africa".

2026 — Center for Gender & Sexuality Studies Grant.

2022 — $3,000, Research funds by The Pearson Institute.

2021 — PhD scholarship by The Pearson Institute.

2015 — Merit scholarship for Master's degree by Bocconi University.

Conference Presentations

Jul 12-14, 2026 — **Violence Prevention Research Conference**
Portsmouth, NH, USA

Oct 06-09, 2025 — **International Society for the Prevention of Child Abuse and Neglect (ISPCAN) Congress**
Vilnius, Lithuania

May 16-17, 2019 — **European Conference on Multi-Agency Response to Gender-Based Violence**
Vilnius, Lithuania

Apr 12-13, 2017 — **Second International Symposium on Gender, Law and Constitutions**
Washington DC, USA

Skills

Languages — English, Hindi & Tamil – Native;
French & Italian – Intermediate;
Arabic & Hawaiian – Basic

Coding — R, Stata, Python, LaTeX

References

- Oeindrila Dube: odube@uchicago.edu
- Anjali Adukia: adukia@uchicago.edu
- Chris Blattman: blattman@uchicago.edu